

Sarayu Kotha

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BSc Economics with Data Science · University of Southampton · Expected First Class · Graduating May 2027

PROFILE

Second-year Economics with Data Science student at Southampton, on track for a first. I'm drawn to the places where numbers meet decisions, whether that's steering a senior racing crew as Captain and Coxswain at 6am in February or building a machine learning model to predict why bank customers churn. My degree has given me the technical grounding; my experiences outside the classroom have taught me how to think fast, communicate clearly, and lead under real pressure. I'm applying to Banking Circle because I want to understand what that intersection looks like inside a real fintech bank and build a career in it.

EDUCATION

BSc Economics with Data Science | *University of Southampton* Sep 2024 – Present

- ▶ On course for a first class degree. Expected graduation: May 2027.
- ▶ Core modules: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Quantitative Modelling in Economics, Statistics for Economics, Economics with Data.
- ▶ Practical skills in statistical analysis, data visualisation, and econometric modelling using R and Excel.

A-Levels | *Queen Mary College, Basingstoke* Sep 2022 – Jun 2024

- ▶ Mathematics (B), Chemistry (A), Biology (A).

GCSEs | *Bishop Challoner Catholic Secondary School, Basingstoke* Sep 2017 – Mar 2022

- ▶ 9 GCSEs at grades 7–8, including Mathematics (8), Physics, Chemistry & Biology (8), Spanish (8), English Literature & Language (7).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Private Tutor | *MyTutor, UK (Remote)* Sep 2025 – Present

- ▶ Deliver one-to-one tutoring in Mathematics and Sciences to A-level and GCSE students, adapting lesson plans to each student's learning style.
- ▶ Manage a portfolio of students independently — consistently receiving strong feedback from students and parents.
- ▶ Builds reliability, clear communication, and the ability to explain complex ideas to people at very different starting points.

Work Experience Intern | *OpenText, Reading, UK* Jul 2025

- ▶ Completed a structured rotation across Software Development, Billing & Revenue, Operational Marketing, and Commercial Law.
- ▶ Gained a cross-functional view of how a global enterprise software company connects its technical, commercial, and legal operations.
- ▶ Developed working knowledge of Agile project management in a fast-paced product environment.

Tutor | *Achievers Academy, Basingstoke, UK* Sep 2021 – Apr 2024

- ▶ Prepared students aged 9–11 for grammar school 11+ entrance exams in verbal reasoning, English, and Mathematics.
- ▶ Helped multiple students gain places at selective schools; built strong communication and mentoring skills over three years of consistent student and parent engagement.

VIRTUAL EXPERIENCE & CERTIFICATIONS

Investment Banking Job Simulation | *J.P. Morgan Chase via Forage*

May 2026

- ▶ Advised a client on M&A target selection across Asian markets, evaluating candidates on strategic, financial, and structural criteria.
- ▶ Applied DCF modelling and company valuation techniques to assess deal feasibility and build investment recommendations.
- ▶ Developed the analytical and communication skills required at analyst level in a top-tier investment bank.

Data Science & Analytics Job Simulation | *Lloyds Banking Group via Forage*

Mar 2026

- ▶ Working on a customer churn prediction project mirroring real graduate-level work at a major UK bank.
- ▶ Conducting exploratory data analysis across multi-source datasets and building a predictive ML model with performance evaluation.
- ▶ Developing skills in translating complex data findings into clear, actionable insights for non-technical stakeholders.

Data Science Job Simulation (BCG X) | *Boston Consulting Group via Forage*

Jul 2025

- ▶ Applied data science and AI techniques to complex business problems in a simulated consulting environment.
- ▶ Strengthened Python and data analysis skills alongside commercial problem-solving.

GenAI Job Simulation | *Boston Consulting Group via Forage*

Jul 2025

- ▶ Built an AI-powered financial chatbot using Python (pandas) to process and interpret 10-K and 10-Q SEC filings, surfacing meaningful financial insights via rule-based logic.

Introduction to Investment Banking Virtual Work Experience | *SpringPod*

Aug 2023

- ▶ Explored M&A advisory, equity underwriting, and asset management through industry webinars and real deal case studies.

SKILLS & TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Technical: Python (pandas — applied in BCG GenAI simulation and data analysis projects), R (data cleaning, descriptive statistics, econometric modelling), Microsoft Excel (data analysis, PivotTables, visualisation), Microsoft Office Suite.

Languages: English (native), Spanish (GCSE).

LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Captain & Coxswain — Senior Rowing Crew | *University of Southampton Rowing Club*

Sep 2024 – Present

- ▶ ▶ Started as Coxswain for the novice crew in first year; promoted to Captain and Coxswain of the senior squad in May 2026 — the most technically demanding cox role in the club.
- ▶ ▶ Responsible for race tactics, crew safety, and real-time decision-making for eight experienced rowers; build detailed race plans by studying each rower's profile and reading course conditions, then adapt strategy under competitive pressure.
- ▶ ▶ Lead pre-session briefings and post-session debriefs, earning trust from athletes who have significantly more time on the water than I do.
- ▶ ▶ Managing the dual demands of captaincy and a full academic load has sharpened how I prioritise, perform under pressure, and recover quickly when things don't go to plan.

Peer Wellbeing Mentor & Head of Form | *Bishop Challoner Catholic Secondary School*

2021 – 2022

- ▶ Provided pastoral support to younger students, building trusted mentoring relationships through empathy and active listening.
- ▶ Took responsibility for the welfare and cohesion of a form group, demonstrating initiative and quiet leadership.

Principal Flautist | *Basingstoke Youth Wind Orchestra*

2018 – 2022

- ▶ Lead chair in a large ensemble. Grade 5 Flute, Trinity College London.